

AN INVITATION

Founders' Circle

A private cohort of six founding partners for the launch year of Peninsula Insider, the modern newsroom for the Mornington Peninsula.

Peninsula Insider is launching.

A new editorial publication for the Mornington Peninsula. Local writing. Original photography. A weekly letter from a named editor. No directory clones, no listicle filler, no clichés. We will publish like a magazine and grow like a magazine, week by week, story by story.

We are looking for six founding partners. Peninsula businesses we admire, told properly. The work is real: a hero feature written by our desk, two seasons of photography, a short film, year-round placement on the section that matters most to you, two newsletter features, a place in our itineraries, a named seat in our masthead.

We are not selling banner space. We do not have an audience to brag about yet. We are at the start of a publication that will spend the next five years becoming the definitive voice of this place. The businesses who join us at the start will be part of how that voice is built, and their stories will be there at the centre of it for as long as the publication runs.

If your venue belongs on this masthead, we would like to talk.

James & Emma

FOUNDERS & EDITORS, PENINSULA INSIDER

II

THE PUBLICATION

A modern newsroom for the Peninsula.

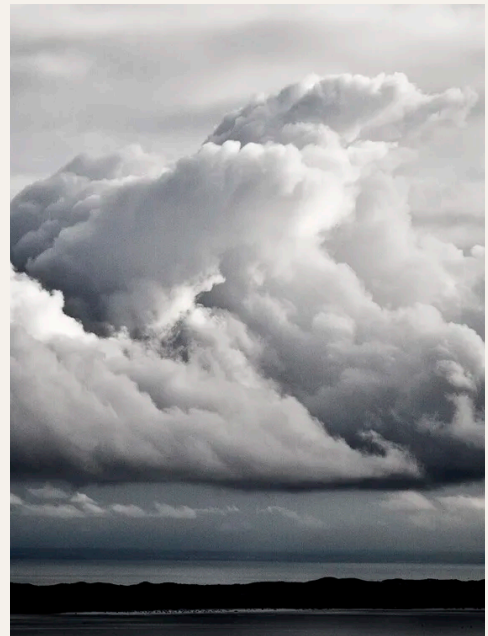
Local first. Editor-led. Published every Thursday. Every claim verified. Every commercial relationship disclosed. Built for digital, not converted to it.

The publication will cover the Peninsula across five pillars: Eat & Drink, Stay, Do, Plan, and the Insider's Journal. The Journal carries a weekly cover story, longform features, interviews with the chefs and winemakers shaping the region, and seasonal guides that go deeper than the destination-marketing copy currently on the internet for this place.

Two products carry the brand. The publication itself, at peninsulainsider.com.au. And The Insider's Letter, a weekly five-minute read sent every Thursday morning, written and signed by the editor.

The bet is simple. There is no category-leading editorial brand for the Mornington Peninsula. Visit Mornington Peninsula is a legacy directory. Broadsheet treats the region as a side note to Melbourne. Easy Weddings and the listicle players have no editorial voice. That position, the local editorial authority, is unowned. We intend to take it.

We will publish like a magazine, and grow like a magazine. Week by week, story by story.



THE HINTERLAND ROAD · RED HILL,
AUTUMN 2026

III

THE FIREWALL

Three rules *hold the line.*

Peninsula Insider takes commercial partnerships. We are open about that. The publication is funded in part by the businesses who appear on it. What we do not do is let those businesses influence the editorial.

i. Curated commercial

Only Peninsula businesses appear on PI. No programmatic, no off-region brands, no Booking.com retargeting filling our sidebar. If a reader sees a partner story or a sponsor placement here, the venue is one we know.

ii. Editor-led

James and Emma sign the editorial. They pick the cover. They never appear at advertiser-only events. The masthead is theirs. The rate card is the publisher's. The two do not meet.

iii. Disclosed by default

Every paid item carries a Partner Content eyebrow. Every founding partner is publicly listed on our about page. Every conflict is declared in the article that touches it. Once a year we publish a one-page firewall audit, naming what we ran, what we declined, and where the line strained.

The differentiator is not "we don't sell." Visit Mornington Peninsula sells. Broadsheet sells. The differentiator is we tell you who is paying, and the editorial does not bend.
peninsulainsider.com.au

IV THE NEWSROOM & THE COHORT

Built as a publication, *not a blog.*

Editorial commissioning runs through a desk model: research, drafting, fact-checking, copy, scheduling, editorial sign-off. Each factual claim is logged with a primary source before draft. Every cover passes editor sign-off before publish. Every Founders' Circle piece is read in full by James or Emma before it goes out.

The result is a five-to-seven-day production cycle on a feature that would take most regional publishers five weeks, at the editorial standard of a national title.

THE COHORT *Six seats, one cohort, two years.*

SEAT 1 A design-led hotel
The hospitality benchmark

SEAT 2 A leading restaurant
Hatted, considered, of the place

SEAT 3 A wine producer
With a serious cellar door

SEAT 4 A wellness operator
Hot springs, day spa, retreat

SEAT 5 An experience or cultural venue
Sculpture, walks, water

SEAT 6 An open seat
Held back for a venue we do not yet know

V

WHAT YOU GET, ACROSS 24 MONTHS

The work, *made real.*

Every deliverable below is real work, produced by our desk, signed off by the editor, photographed by our contracted photographer, hosted permanently on the publication.

EDITORIAL

- **One hero feature.** Two thousand to twenty-five hundred words, researched by our desk, drafted to PI standard, signed off by the editor. The most ambitious piece of writing your venue will appear in this year, anywhere.
- **One photo essay.** Twelve to fifteen original images. Two days of shooting across two seasons. Partner receives a non-exclusive licence to reuse the imagery in their own marketing.
- **One short film.** Sixty to ninety seconds, scripted and shot to the publication's house treatment. Lives on your venue page and rotates on the homepage cover for one season.

PLACEMENT

- **Year-round priority placement** on the section hub most relevant to you. Capped at one founding partner per slot.
- **One quarter as the homepage cover story** across the two-year window. Scheduled in agreement with you for the season that suits your business.
- **Two newsletter features**, written by the desk, run in The Insider's Letter twice across the year. Editorial features, not banner ads.
- **Embedding in at least two pre-built itineraries** and the Build-Your-Own planner, where your venue belongs in the recommendation.



RECOGNITION

- **Permanent listing as a Founding Partner** on the masthead, the about page, the kit, and the footer of every Insider's Letter.
- **One annual partner dinner**, hosted by James and Emma, for the cohort only. No press, no microphones, no formal program. The conversation is the point.

THE CARRY-FORWARD PROMISE

When the publication's audience triples, your hero feature, your photo essay, your film, and your venue page travel with it. Stories written in our launch year will still be the canonical PI feature on your venue when our newsletter is at fifty thousand subscribers.

THE UNDERRATED BENEFIT OF BUYING IN EARLY

2,500
HERO FEATURE WORDS

15
ORIGINAL PHOTOGRAPHS

90"
SHORT FILM, HOUSE CUT

2
NEWSLETTER FEATURES PER YEAR

1q
HOMEPAGE COVER STORY

∞
PERMANENCE ON THE MASTHEAD

VII INVESTMENT, SEQUENCE, CONTACT

A locked rate for *two years*.

\$15,000/yr

AUD per year, ex GST.
Locked at this rate for two years.
Total commitment: \$30,000.

PAYMENT TERMS

- **50%** on signing. Funds editorial production and the first season of photography.
- **25%** at month six.
- **25%** at month twelve.
- **Year two** payable annually in advance at the same locked rate.

For comparison: a single double-page advertorial in a national trade title runs \$8,000 to \$11,000 for one issue and disappears with the next print run. A two-day hotel photography commission runs \$4,000 to \$7,000. A one-time sponsored article in a lifestyle publication runs \$5,000 to \$9,000, links die with the campaign. Founders' Circle delivers all three, plus year-round placement, plus the masthead seat.

SEQUENCE

- 01. Initial conversation
WHENEVER SUITS YOU
- 02. Cohort agreement signed, 50% paid
WITHIN FOUR WEEKS
- 03. First photography sitting
WITHIN SIX WEEKS OF SIGNING
- 04. Hero feature published
WITHIN TEN WEEKS OF SIGNING
- 05. Year-two renewal locked
AT MONTH EIGHTEEN

CONTACT

James & Emma

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We respond personally, usually within forty-eight hours. The cohort closes on 30 June, or when six seats are filled.